



Rule-based protection for your portfolio, with an AI analyst on staff.

Canary Desk runs your risk rules on the live book: trailing stops, loss exits, a budget for option premium and a cash sweep for idle money. While your Mac stays awake, it places the orders you have pre-authorised, even when you're away, and drafts the rest for your approval. Before each open, its AI analyst briefs you on the markets and your book.

What the rules watch

Stops and exits. Trailing stops, loss exits and profit trails, with one order per contract however many rules ask.

Option premium budget. Long premium at risk, hedges excluded, is watched at 25 % of NLV, 15 % in stress. Above it the book is sell-only: new buys are warned, not blocked.

Ranked sell plan. At 35 % of NLV, Canary ranks what to sell by what each sale fixes and drafts the sales. Off by default.

Canary's defaults, September 2026. You set every level.

Margin and exposure. Excess liquidity is flagged below 30 % of NLV and again below 15 %, and new buys are warned. Net exposure bands narrow in stress.

Idle cash. Cash above a buffer buys a ladder of short-dated government bills in the same currency, or an ETF you name; below it, the nearest bill is sold. Off by default.

Market regime. Canary's sensors read volatility, credit, funding, currency, dealer gamma and breadth. As they signal stress, your limits tighten.

You set how far it goes.

	WHAT HAPPENS	YOUR PART	DEFAULT
	Proposals. Rules draft orders and the AI analyst suggests adds, holds, trims and exits. Nothing is sent.	Read and decide.	On.
	Confirmed orders. DAY limit orders and Canary's exact proposals go to the broker after you check its preview.	Confirm each at the Mac: passkey, Touch ID or a paired Apple Watch.	Off until you enable trading.
	Queued for the open. A reduction you confirm before the open goes out in a one-hour window after it, as a limit order, only while its rule applies.	Confirm once, before the open.	With trading enabled.
	Pre-authorised rules. Stops, exits, budget cuts and the cash sweep go out on their own when a veto window ends, 30 minutes by default, each capped at an order size you set.	Pre-authorise each in your policy. Veto inside the window from Canary's paired app.	Off.

The AI analyst proposes but never sends. Every order, from you or from a rule, passes the checks of Canary, the open-source broker layer underneath, against your limits, and leaves a receipt. Rules only shrink a position, apart from the cash sweep, which buys bills, or an ETF you name, with free cash.

A day with Canary Desk.



Canary Desk

Market context, portfolio review and an AI analyst in one daily workspace, on a fixed clock.

A WEEKDAY WITH US HOLDINGS · BERLIN TIME

■ Brief ● Review ○ Market



Every figure shows its source and its age. Xetra, London, Tokyo and Hong Kong follow the same clock; a material change starts a review in between.

Context and review

Written briefs. Before each open: markets, headlines on your holdings, how the book did. One model writes, a second edits.

Edge. What past trades delivered, confirmed by the broker, against leaving the position unchanged. History, not a forecast.

An analyst you can question. It answers from a snapshot of your broker data; a second model checks each answer.

Performance. Time-weighted return from broker statements, net of transfers, with drawdown, against SPY.

Who is carrying the market. Ten leaders against SPY and QQQ on price, breadth above the 50-day average and trading activity.

Market data. Streaming quotes and day charts, an index ribbon, and a calendar of releases and earnings.

Around the clock

On a Mac mini. Run it day and night on a dedicated Mac mini. Your laptop connects over a private, encrypted link; the rules keep running when it sleeps.

Rules that act. Pre-authorized stops, exits, budget cuts and the cash sweep go out when their veto window ends. Everything else waits for you.

On your phone. Canary's paired app shows alerts and can veto a pending order; away from home it needs the optional remote relay.

Notifications. Orders waiting for you, risk-policy and mode changes, and data problems reach your Mac or laptop.

Stops at the broker. A placed trailing stop rests at Interactive Brokers, for the day or until cancelled.

When a machine stops. If TWS logs out, rules stop and Desk flags it. If the Mac running Desk sleeps, nothing runs there; orders already at the broker keep working.

What it is not

- **No claim of edge.** Results are measured, not promised; a stop can fill below its trigger.
- **One person, one account.** No roles, no second approver, no other brokers, no Windows or Linux.
- **Not a money mover.** It places orders; it cannot withdraw or transfer funds.
- **Not a data vendor.** No licensed news or consensus data.
- **Single-leg options only.** Multi-leg and adjusted options are shown, not traded.

A small private preview. Built by Oliver Sauer, who runs his own portfolio on it. Runs on your Mac with Interactive Brokers and your OpenAI account. Preview access is arranged personally.

More at osauer.dev/desk · linkedin.com/in/osauer

Full features



Canary Desk

Levels are Canary's defaults as of September 2026, and you set every one.

Market context

- Market regime from eight readings in six groups: volatility, credit, funding, currency, dealer gamma and breadth.
- Stress is confirmed only when the groups agree; missing data is named, never read as calm.
- Who is carrying the market: ten leaders against SPY and QQQ on price, breadth and activity.
- An economic calendar with official releases and outcomes, and earnings checks for your holdings.
- A live index ribbon, the VIX term structure and session calendars for five exchanges.

Portfolio and performance

- Net liquidation, day P&L, margin headroom, cash, realised and unrealised P&L at a glance.
- Time-weighted return and drawdown from broker statements, against SPY.
- Holdings with streaming quotes, day charts, 52-week ranges and option legs.
- Contribution breakdown; allocation by underlying, industry and asset class.
- Reconciliation status from broker statements, and an evidence panel per position.

Risk and rules

- Canary's risk assessment: exposure, margin, financing, option Greeks and stress findings.
- A rulebook of 19 rules with limits you set, from issuer concentration to margin headroom.
- Limits that tighten with the regime, and a sell-only state when premium or exposure runs over.
- One risk-policy word on every view, and a drawdown brake from your own policy.

Operations

- Runs around the clock on a Mac mini; your laptop connects for the console, approvals and notifications.
- AUTO or MANUAL with the cause recorded; it drops to MANUAL on a fault.
- A menu-bar companion and a status monitor.
- A data panel that names every gap; follow-ups and a timeline of the day.
- A model-spend ledger with an allowance and a hard ceiling; a simulation mode on a synthetic book.

Protection and orders

- Drafted by rule: trailing stops, loss exits, profit trails, expiry and time-decay closes, trims and budget cuts.
- A ranked sell plan at the premium cap, and a cash sweep into same-currency government bills.
- One order per contract, and orders queued for the open at a bounded limit.
- Pre-authorised rules act after a veto window, capped at an order size you set.
- Every other order confirmed by passkey, Touch ID or Apple Watch.
- A receipt for every attempt and a reference for every refusal.

AI analyst and briefs

- Briefs at 08:30, before the US open and at 18:00 Berlin time, plus a Saturday edition.
- One model writes, a second edits; a plain edition from the facts if a run fails.
- Reviews on the market's clock, and in between when the book changes.
- Ask Canary Desk, checked by a second model; proposals with reasons, sources and an expiry.
- Edge: a broker-confirmed review of what past trades delivered.
- Research from official sources: Fed, BLS, BEA, ECB, SEC, Treasury and FRED.

Privacy and data

- Runs on your Macs. No cloud service, no telemetry, nothing sent to the maker.
- Leaves the Mac: orders to Interactive Brokers, requests for public data and news, and OpenAI calls with the book data each answer needs.
- The broker connection stays in Canary; the AI has read-only tools.

What you need

- A Mac that stays awake and logged in, or a dedicated Mac mini.
- Interactive Brokers via TWS or IB Gateway, logged in by you, with Flex statements.
- An OpenAI API key or a ChatGPT account.
- For Touch ID approvals, macOS 26 or later with a Secure Enclave.